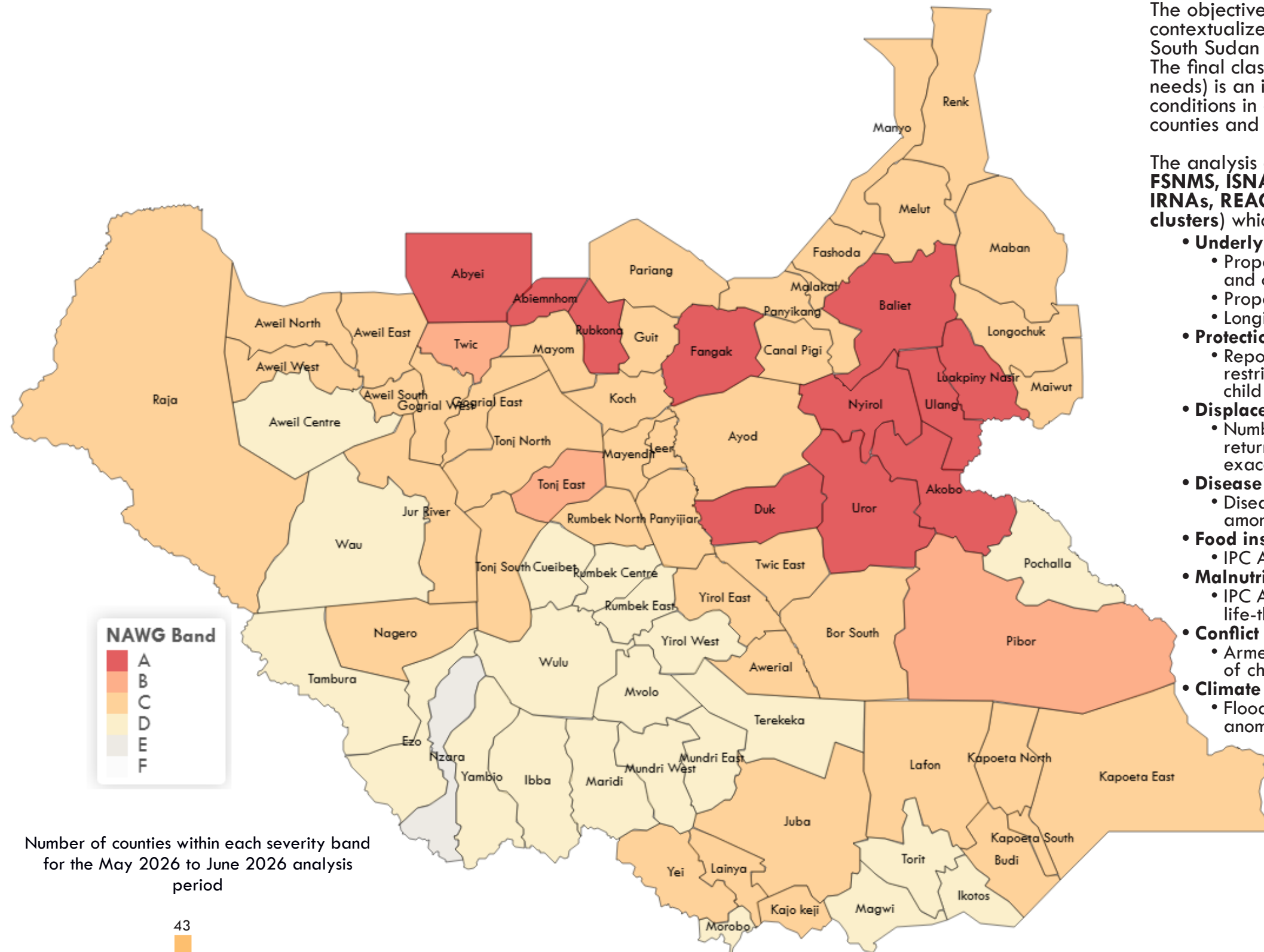


SOUTH SUDAN – NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

May 2026 – June 2026 Analysis



For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Kumudu Sanjeewa (sanjeewa@un.org) or Mary Langan (mary.langan@impact-initiatives.org).

Background

The NAWG meeting was held on July 7, 2026 to discuss the analysis of the **May 2026 to June 2026** period.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of critical life-saving humanitarian needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization by the ICCG. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The analysis encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, ACLED, INSO, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as a significant number of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used as a proxy for life-threatening acute malnutrition and excess mortality risk.
- **Conflict**
 - Armed conflict events, conflict-related sexual violence, forced recruitment of children, targeted killings of civilians, targeted property destruction
- **Climate shocks**
 - Flood-related displacement, flood extent, drought stress, rainfall anomalies.

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B	7 - 7.9	Very severe humanitarian conditions
C	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions
D	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
E	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
F	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

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The May to June 2026 NAWG analysis shows a broadly stable humanitarian picture with a slight deteriorating tilt. The mean Needs Severity Score edged up from 6.26 to 6.31, the eleven Band A counties are unchanged, and 71 of 79 counties remained in the same band. Movement is largely a conflict story: a broad rise in incident-based scores nudged around 30 counties up, partially offset by easing displacement and disease signals.

Return, not flight, dominates the displacement signal: around 90,000 individuals were tracked on the move, overwhelmingly spontaneous returns, more than 46,000 of them to Akobo, where water, health and nutrition services have collapsed.

The April to July 2026 IPC projection remains unchanged. Pockets of the population in Akobo, Fangak, Nyirol, Uror, Luakpiny/Nasir and Ulang are in IPC Phase 5 (Catastrophe), and a credible risk of Famine has been identified in the most affected, inaccessible areas of Upper Nile and Jonglei. A new signal is an emerging dry outlook: June rainfall was about 71 per cent of the long-term average, and below-average rainfall and above-average temperatures are forecast through September. The national cholera outbreak totalled 107,779 cases and 1,706 deaths, with Unity State accounting for about 95 per cent of recent cases.

Counties Facing “Extreme” Humanitarian Conditions

Eleven counties were classified as experiencing **extreme humanitarian needs (Band A)** this cycle, unchanged from the previous analysis. These counties are **Akobo, Nyirol, Luakpiny/Nasir, Uror, Duk, Fangak, Rubkona, Ulang, Baliet, Abiemnhom and Abyei**. Four reach Band A on score alone; the remaining seven are held there by the IPC malnutrition Phase 5 restriction.

Discussion and Joint Analysis

Longochuk: Moved down a full band on reduced displacement, protection and conflict signals, though this reflects the timing of movement, not improvement on the ground. A mid-June assessment found 22,000 people in Udier payam in urgent need, with global acute malnutrition above 40 per cent, no functional boreholes and no food distribution since December 2025. No assistance is reaching the county. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**

Jur River: A mid-June outbreak of intercommunal violence over grazing land displaced several thousand people. Displacement tracking recorded around 6,357 people displaced within the county, concentrated in two payams, while protection monitoring reported approximately 5,000 displaced after the clashes. Members estimated between 10,000 and 15,000 displaced, with populations still moving and sheltering in schools and churches, and no response yet mounted. **Final classification: Elevated to Band C.**

Renk: Remains the primary entry and concentration point for people crossing from Sudan, with over 4,400 new arrivals recorded in the first half of June as fighting intensified across the border. The transit centre held about 6,000 people against a 3,000-person capacity. The county is a cholera hotspot and recorded the highest cropland stress nationally in the June agricultural data, alongside rainfall well below the seasonal norm. It was put forward as a possible elevation candidate. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**

Canal/Pigi: Moved down from Band B to Band C on reduced displacement and protection signals. Displacement tracking recorded no events this cycle, yet authorities called for support for displaced returnees across several payams, with figures still being verified, while ongoing clashes between government and opposition forces continued to restrict access. Members noted that access remains one of the greatest operational challenges in the county. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**

Leer: Moved down from Band B to Band C, reversing its move up last cycle. It remains one of the Unity counties where cholera transmission persists and is included in the approved mop-up oral cholera vaccination campaign. Localised clashes between government-aligned armed youth and opposition forces were recorded in late May. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**

Nagero: Did not change band, but an inter-agency assessment in mid-June documented a large, previously unverified caseload of 66,992 conflict-affected displaced people and returnees across five payams, displaced since clashes in late 2025 and compounded by intercommunal land disputes. It left markets looted, health facilities destroyed and road access cut, with critical malnutrition and unaddressed protection concerns. Because the displacement predates this cycle and access had been denied, it was not captured in displacement tracking. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**

Pochalla: Recorded the largest needs severity increase nationally this cycle while remaining in Band D. In mid-June, an attack on a military position triggered clashes that displaced hundreds of civilians towards the Ethiopian border. Satellite data recorded the highest flood extent nationally, and the county is flagged for elevated drought and water-stress risk. **Final classification: Maintained in Band D.**

Tonj North, Tonj South and Tonj East: The three counties are at the centre of a deteriorating protection environment in Warrap, driven by feuds between rival community sub-sections and cross-border cattle raids, with the associated loss of crops and livestock sharply worsening food security. Tonj South recorded the heaviest conflict toll among the counties flagged, with nine events and 19 fatalities around Tonj town, while Tonj East holds the joint-highest needs severity score in Band B. Members noted that Tonj East is slightly more severe than the other two. **Final classification: All three maintained, Tonj East in Band B and Tonj North and Tonj South in Band C.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to track the evolving situation and share any relevant information. **All 11 Band A counties remain under close monitoring by default, and Lafon was added to the list during the meeting.**

Close monitoring is recommended across the cholera and flood corridor of Unity, Lakes and Jonglei. Aerial remains the principal cholera hotspot in Lakes, and Panyijiar and Mayom are among the Unity counties where transmission continues, with Mayom reporting the second-highest caseload after Rubkona and included in the approved mop-up vaccination campaign. Panyijiar and Ayod remain highly flood-exposed as the rains progress, although Ayod recorded flooding below its long-term average for June.

Further monitoring is recommended where conflict and protection risks are shifting. Pibor and Twic both moved up a band on rising conflict scores, Twic under sustained cross-border cattle-raiding pressure and following a mass nutrition screening that returned global acute malnutrition rates above 25 per cent. Raja moved up on rising friction around movements from Sudan, and Tambura recorded one of the largest conflict-score increases nationally. Malakal and Wau both moved down and warrant monitoring of whether the improvement holds, with newly proposed travel-permit requirements raising access concerns across Upper Nile.

Drought and cross-border disease risks warrant monitoring in the east and north-east. The three Kapoeta counties and Lafon are flagged for the emerging drought and water-stress risk, with about 1,500 people reported to have moved from around Kapoeta towards Kenya owing to water scarcity and a field mission planned to verify conditions in Lafon. Maban registered the second-highest cropland stress nationally, an early drought signal, while Magwi is a priority county for Ebola preparedness given continued cross-border movement.